

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: I want to speak to your boss, now!



Learning Outcome

Identify and provide solutions to problems in a range of social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you properly completed a customer complaint form before? If yes, when?
- When would a person complete one? What is poor customer service?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about customer service.
- I can write a customer complaint.
- I can describe behavior and personality.





Let's Explore!

Listen to a disappointed customer's letter of complaint. Do you think she is being **reasonable***?

* Fair and sensible.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Sir / Madam,

I am writing to air my feelings about our visit to your restaurant, Zanzibar, on the 4th of June. The service was so poor, that our evening was spoiled!
I called the restaurant last month to book a table at 8 p.m. I later received a confirmation regarding my booking by email that said:

- 1) we had a window table so we could look out at the harbor.
- 2) my daughters (6 and 8 years old) would receive free children's meals.
- 3) there was a special, perfect for vegetarians.

When we promptly arrived at the restaurant, the waiter hastily ushered us to a table next to the kitchen and away from a view. When I kindly tried to explain that we booked a table elsewhere, the waiter swiftly became rude and unhelpful.

Secondly, the vegetarian special was not available. This showed a clear lack of communication on your part. How can you advertise for vegetarians and then not meet those customers' needs?

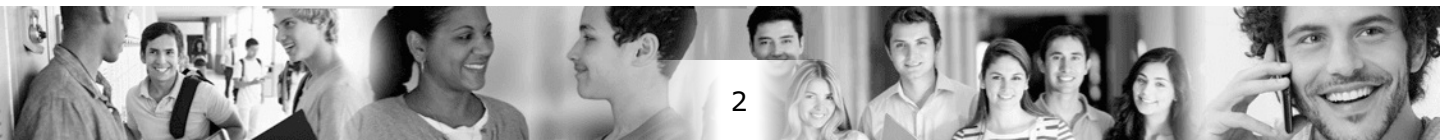
Thirdly, when we asked for the bill, it was incorrect. Our waiter charged the children's meals to my credit card as well! When I pointed out that we were told these would be free of charge, he told me to talk to the manager.

Overall, we felt the ambiance was extremely unwelcoming. Our waiter was unprofessional, inattentive and curt. It was very disappointing indeed.

I enclose a copy of the bill.

I look forward to receiving your response.

Yours faithfully,
Ms. Janine King





Let's Practice!

Can you describe how something happened or how someone behaved?

Instructions: Fill in the blanks with the appropriate adverb from this list: kindly, Promptly, sadly, angrily, happily, hastily, swiftly, excitedly. Using the sentences, model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. Dinner was cold so the customer complained to the chef _____.
2. The kids ran to the park _____.
3. The boy said _____ "someone took my ball".
4. The writer answered _____ "don't worry, I will get you another one right away".



Let's Practice!

Do you know how to write about customer service?

Instructions: Circle the adverbs in each sentence. Using the sentences, model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. When I kindly tried to explain that we booked a table elsewhere, the waiter ushered us to a table away from the view.
2. When we promptly arrived at the restaurant, the waiter swiftly became rude and unhelpful.
3. We felt the whole ambiance was very disappointing indeed.
4. It was very unprofessional with no care and attention.
5. The vegetarian special was not available.
6. This showed a clear lack of communication, poor customer service and lack of interest in meeting customer's needs.





Extension Activity

Can you help a family member with a customer complaint?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Interview a family member about a time they received poor customer service.
- Write down the details in note form.
- Then, turn your notes into a 80-100 word customer complaint.
- Use adverbs of manner to describe how things are done.
- Read your customer complaint aloud to the family member when done.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I interview a family member about receiving poor customer service.

☐ ☐

I write down notes from the interview.

☐ ☐

I write a customer complaint.

☐ ☐

I read the customer complaint aloud to your partner when done.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to air** (verb): to make something known in public
e.g. I am writing to air my feelings about our visit to your restaurant, Zanzibar.
- **promptly** (adverb): to do something without delay
e.g. We promptly arrived at the restaurant at 8 p.m.
- **hastily** (adverb): done or made very quickly
e.g. The waiter hastily ushered us to a table next to the kitchen and away from a view.
- **swiftly** (adverb): done quickly or immediately
e.g. The waiter swiftly became rude and unhelpful.
- **elsewhere** (adverb): in or to another place
e.g. When I kindly tried to explain that we booked a table elsewhere, the waiter swiftly became rude and unhelpful.
- **ambiance** (noun): the mood or feeling of a particular place
e.g. Overall, we felt the ambiance was extremely unwelcoming.
- **indeed** (adverb): without any question
e.g. It was very disappointing indeed.
- **faithfully** (adverb): having or showing true and constant trust
e.g.
Yours faithfully,
Ms. Janine King





Learning Points

Writing a Customer Complaint

Here are some example sentences to include in a customer complaint letter.

Greeting:

Dear Sir,
Dear Madam,
Company Name,

Remember to use a comma after the greeting.

Closing:

If you know the person's name - *Yours sincerely,* or *Sincerely yours*
If you don't know the person's name - *Yours truly,* or *Yours faithfully,*

Phrases you can use to describe a situation:

I am writing to inform you of my dissatisfaction with ...
I am writing to inquire about ...

Phrases you can use to describe a problem:

I had difficulty in ...
On March 1st, I ...

Phrases you can use to describe a solution:

I enclose a copy of the invoice ...
Could I please ask you to ...

Phrase to use to finish your letter of complaint

I look forward to receiving your response.
Please do not hesitate to contact me if you have any more questions.





Learning Points

Adverbs of Manner

You use adverbs of manner to describe how something is done.

Example: She walked slowly.

How did she walk? Slowly.

Many adverbs are formed by adding **-ly** to an adjective:

Examples: sad - sadly, curious - curiously

Some adverbs are formed by adding **-ally**:

Example: comic - comically

The adverbs **fast**, **hard**, **well** and **straight** are exceptions.

Examples:

- *The waiter hastily ushered us to a table.*
- *I kindly tried to explain that we booked a table elsewhere.*

